

SENATE No. 673

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Bruce E. Tarr

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act establishing the New England Fusion Research Compact.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	
<i>Bruce E. Tarr</i>	<i>First Essex and Middlesex</i>	
<i>Peter J. Durant</i>	<i>Worcester and Hampshire</i>	<i>3/13/2025</i>

SENATE No. 673

By Mr. Tarr, a petition (accompanied by bill, Senate, No. 673) of Bruce E. Tarr for legislation to establish the New England Fusion Research Compact. Environment and Natural Resources.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act establishing the New England Fusion Research Compact.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION 1. The Secretary of Energy and Environmental Affairs, in consultation with
2 the Massachusetts Clean Energy Center, is hereby authorized and directed to develop and
3 implement the framework of a regional compact among the states of Massachusetts, New
4 Hampshire, Maine, Vermont, and Connecticut for the purposes of research and development
5 regarding energy produced by nuclear fusion. Said compact shall include, but not be limited to,
6 the mission of the compact, specific focus areas, personnel and financial requirements, and other
7 elements necessary to the operation of the compact.

8 SECTION 2. The compact shall include the development and implementation of a
9 comprehensive plan to obtain all necessary regulatory approvals for, finance, and operate, one or
10 more nuclear fusion reactors for research, provided that the costs of such actions shall be
11 addressed by a formula to facilitate fair contributions from each member state, together with any
12 gifts or grants, including but not limited to those provided by the United States Department of

13 Energy. Such plan may include recommendations for regulatory or statutory measures to assess
14 regulated energy companies for costs associated with the compact.

15 SECTION 3. The secretary shall establish a Fusion Research Council to provide guidance
16 in carrying out the provisions of this act. Said council shall consist of the secretary, who shall
17 serve as its chair, the executive director of the clean energy center, the secretary of economic
18 development or a designee, the commissioner of the department of environmental protection or a
19 designee, and 7 members appointed by the governor, whom shall include individuals
20 representing 3 institutions of higher learning in the commonwealth, 1 of which shall be the
21 University of Massachusetts and 1 of which shall be the Massachusetts Institute of Technology,
22 1 member representing employers in the commonwealth, 1 member representing organized
23 labor in the commonwealth, 1 member representing an organization engaged in independent
24 nuclear energy research in the commonwealth, and 1 member representing the taxpayers of the
25 commonwealth. The council shall convene as deemed necessary by its chair, but not less than
26 quarterly.

27 SECTION 4. The secretary, in accordance with the plan developed pursuant to this act,
28 and subject to the approval of the governor and the great and general court, shall solicit member
29 states for participation in the compact, provided that such states shall designate representatives
30 according to the terms of the compact. Representatives shall serve for a term, and under such
31 conditions, as the state being represented shall establish.

32 SECTION 5. The secretary shall submit the plan developed pursuant to section 1 in the
33 form of legislation filed with the clerk of the Senate not later than 12 months following the
34 passage of this act, the passage of which shall constitute the approval prescribed in section 4.

35 SECTION 6. The secretary shall file reports detailing the progress made in the
36 development of the compact, any costs estimates for its implementation, and any
37 recommendations for legislative or regulatory actions to advance the mission of the compact, not
38 less than every three months, with the clerks of the House and Senate, the Joint Committee on
39 Telecommunications and Energy, and the House and Senate Committees on Ways and Means.